

PORUS
IRANI

35. HOUSEHOLD SERVICES PROVIDER
DIRECTOR, HANDIMAN
SERVICES LIMITED
INITIAL INVESTMENT IN 1998 Rs 20 lakh
CURRENT TURNOVER Rs 35 crore

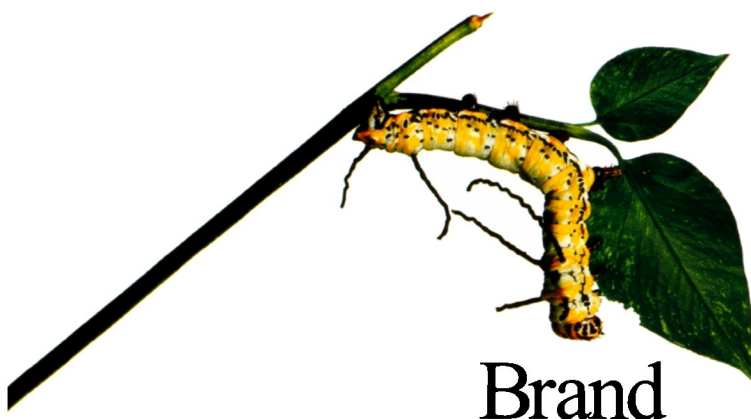
CLEAN DREAMS

So the party last night was a blast, but have you considered the clean-up? If you've been wondering whether someone could do it for you, call for the dust-buster plan of Porus Irani, director, Bangalore-based Handiman Services. "We provide post-party cleaning services and even shampoo the carpets if a customer wants," says Irani. That's not all. One of India's biggest facility management firms, Handiman maintains big housing and office complexes and offers a host of services that range from housekeeping to interior fitouts.

Irani set up Handiman in 1998. His father Behram Irani had an electrical contracting business, but Porus thought bigger. With Rs 20 lakh from family and friends, he set up a 1,500-sq-ft office on Brunton Road in

Bangalore and started supplying electricians, plumbers and carpenters in his neighbourhood. Irani studied at night college (Baldwin Methodist College) so that he could run his business by the day.

He soon realised that he needed bigger clients than his neighbours. Raheja Group, one of Bangalore's biggest real estate companies, maintained a road divider on one of Bangalore's central streets, Residency Road. The group asked him to clean up the grilles on the road divider. Irani took seven nights to do it and under-quoted himself, so finally didn't make any money. But the Rahejas offered him maintenance of three of their housing complexes, where handy-men would take care of security, house-keeping, engineering services, electrical



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